

Seek advice from a specialist at the time of purchase.

Container-grown trees can be planted at any time of year, although spring or fall are preferable; ensure that they have not become pot-bound when you choose your tree. Plant bare-root trees between fall and early spring as long as the ground is not frozen. Pears need a warm, sheltered, sunny site with well-draining, fertile soil, and a pH of around 6.5. Dig in plenty of well-rotted manure or compost before planting—a thin, acidic, or chalky soil can encourage lime-induced chlorosis.

CROP CARE

Pear trees will require careful watering, especially while young



Thin out fruits to encourage large growth.

or during their growing season—do not allow them to dry out. Pears will need to be fed with a balanced or nitrogenous fertilizer in late winter, and then weeding and mulching with well-rotted manure or compost in spring.

If your tree produces lots of fruits, thin them out to encourage the tree to channel its energy into

TIP PRUNING

Pear trees should be pruned in winter while the tree is dormant to reduce the risk of infection. Cut back any diseased wood and aim to improve ventilation through the branches. If training the tree, prune to encourage directed growth and tie in where necessary (see right). Do not overprune, since too much pruning can encourage an excess of leafy growth and fewer fruits.



Tie in branches with twine or garden string to guide growth for training.